

3D AUTHORIZING SOFTWARE

Working with 3D software has always been difficult as the learning curve has been rather steep. During the past year, we've seen that developers have focussed on this point and the newer packages available today have become extremely simple to use. The various features and capabilities have been made more intuitive. Infusing easy-to-use animation capabilities and filter effects, and extending the software's functions so that you have tools that make it easier to create 3D models have definitely eased things. All this has made it possible for one to concentrate on the work rather than spend time and effort in first learning how to operate the software.

One profound improvement added in 3D authoring software is the extensive animation capability. Greater realism is the catch phrase for the future. Whether it is the generation of digital hair, or the fluid motion of virtual characters and ultra-realistic textures, 3D authoring software today can do it all.

There will continue to be improvements on this front as processing speeds go higher and 3D engines incorporate the features of a new generation of graphics cards.



3D Studio Max R4

A well-integrated toolbar that can be highly customised to render excellent quality 3D models and animations

This application gets top honours because of its great tool integration and uncomplicated interface. It incorporates new features such as improved rendering and modelling options and an improved compositing tool. There are new character animation functions and powerful animation and environmental effects that make it simple to design even a complex sequence of movement. All this adds up to make it the tool of choice for designers and animators.

- + Extremely easy to use
- + Provides great animation and modelling capabilities

Price: Rs 1,41,000

Contact: Autodesk

Phone: 022-6952000

Fax: 022-8397337

Web site: www.autodesk.com

Reviewed in: March 2001

Worthy Mentions

Maya3D

- + Many plugins available
- + Ideal for professional use

Price: NA

Contact: TATA Elxsi

Phone: 080-8360223/92

Fax: 080-8259701/68

Web site: www.aliaswavefront.com

Reviewed in: March 2001

LightWave6

- + Outstanding modelling capabilities

Price: Rs 1,30,000

Contact: Shaf Broadcast

Phone: 022-8753709

Fax: 022-8728551

Web site: www.newtek.com

Reviewed in: March 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: NA1999: 3D Studio Max 2.5
1998: Autodesk AutoCAD R14

ACCOUNTING SOFTWARE

Accounting software has come a long way from the old DOS-based applications just supporting the basic data entry and reporting into a totally GUI-based user interface. These software today have the capability of creating and generating loads of reports ranging from a simple cash/bank book to MIS level reports—all with just a few clicks.

Home users now have tools that help them calculate their taxes and returns thereby making their year-end account closing easier. It's a breeze to manage stocks and shares and calculate earnings with these packages. With

features such as online representation of figures by way of graphs and multi-level reporting, accounting software has become a powerful financial tool for home as well as corporate users.



FACT 19



With the capability to provide users an option for branch level accounting as well as inventory, it can be customised for personal as well as SOHO segment use

This powerful number-crunching software is packed with features that suit not only home users but also companies with offices in multiple locations. It has an easy-to-use interface and user level security. The software comes along with detailed documentation and using it is easy, even for a novice. Apart from the regular features, it also includes an excellent graphical user interface, and can be used by multiple users.

- + Extensive features
 - + Good reporting capabilities
- Price:** Rs 14,500
Contact: Vedika Software

Phone: 022-5006490
Fax: 033-2400824
E-mail: info@vedika.com
Reviewed in: June 2001

Worthy Mentions

EX Next Generation 1.5

- + Good data security
 - + Small software installation
- Price:** Rs 9,500
Contact: Tata Consultancy Services
Phone: 022-8774081
Fax: 022-8777441
E-mail: jaideep_mudholkar@mumbai.tcs.co.in
Web site: www.tcs.com
Reviewed in: June 2001

Wings 2000 Pro

- + Supports multiple languages
- Price:** Rs 18,000
Contact: Wings Infonet
Phone: 040-3211458
Fax: 040-3237318
E-mail: info@wings2000.com
Web site: www.wings2000.com
Reviewed in: June 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: NA 1999: Wings for Windows
1998: EX Next Generation 1.0